

Utah State Charter School Board of Education
250 East 500 South
PO Box 144200
Salt Lake City, UT 84114-4200

Re: Addendum to previous letter from Kalynn Snow, Math Instructor, Vista Charter School

Dear Board Members,

In December 2023, I resigned from my position teaching middle school math at Vista Charter School in Ivins, Utah. My prior letter to the board went into great depth explaining the reasons for that happening. I have moved on and only make this addendum because of my great concern for the students and for my colleagues in the math department who since my departure, have also resigned or been dismissed. Of the four middle school math teachers beginning the 2023-2024 school year, none are left.

My first concern relates to the safety of the students. Instances of bullying and abuse have been ignored or covered up rather than addressed according to official or possibly even legal protocol. This has caused fear, distrust, and vulnerability to students and their families.

Another concern is the lack of effectiveness of the math curriculum chosen and blindly supported by the administration. I discussed this in detail in my prior correspondence. It has been disheartening to see, even after my departure, the failure of the administration to allow instructors to be free to pursue instruction methods that yield the best results. The administration has unyieldingly supported a predetermined curriculum and teaching delivery method which has not been successful. They appear to be more loyal to a vendor than to their faculty and students.

These concerns have resulted in low morale in the school community; faculty, staff, students and even parents. The level of distrust of the administration is alarming and unacceptable. When concerns have been brought to the administration, there seems to be no search for solutions, only blame and fault pushed back to the faculty members.

I respectfully request that the Board perform an investigation which is detailed enough to feel like the above concerns are understood and addressed.

Sincerely,

Kalynn B. Snow